MODULE 7

The best leaders aren't missed when they leave because everything falls apart.

They are honored because the team they built continues to thrive.

TEAM & ORGANIZATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

The team that agrees on everything and never openly disagrees is almost certainly not performing at its best.

- Artificial harmony is one of the most damaging dynamics in healthcare teams — and it looks like professionalism.
- The Five Dysfunctions build on each other: absence of trust underlies all the others.
- Trust is not a character trait. It's vulnerability-based — and the manager goes first.

KEY INSIGHT
Do people on your team feel safe to raise a concern, admit a mistake, or challenge an idea? How do you actually know?

The busyness that keeps you from developing your team is produced by the development you're not doing.

- If more of your team members were more capable, you would have more time — not less.
- Most managers have performance conversations. Fewer have genuine development conversations.
- GROW: Goal, Reality, Options, Way Forward. The coach asks the questions. The coachee generates the answers.

KEY INSIGHT
When did you last have a conversation with each direct report about where they want to be in two years?

3 WORKFORCE PLANNING

The most expensive workforce failure is discovering someone's intention to leave after they've already decided.

- Replacing one skilled employee costs 50-150% of their annual salary — and that's before accounting for lost institutional knowledge.
- The stay conversation: what keeps you here? What would make you consider leaving? Most managers never ask.
- Single-point-of-failure dependency is not a staffing inconvenience. It is an organizational risk.

KEY INSIGHT
If your most operationally critical team member gave notice tomorrow, how disrupted would your practice be? Is that acceptable?

Your culture is not what you say. It is what you model, reward, and tolerate — especially on a hard Tuesday.

- The most powerful culture-shaping lever is also the most invisible: what the manager tolerates.
- One standard applies to everyone, every time. Exceptions become the new floor.
- Silence in response to a behavior that contradicts your stated values is a cultural decision.

KEY INSIGHT
Name one behavior you have been tolerating on your team that contradicts the culture you say you're building.

The problem that keeps returning was never properly reviewed the first time. Reminder emails are not root cause analysis.

- After-Action Review: Intent, Actuality, Comparison, Learning, specific owned Action.
- An AAR without a specific action is a conversation — useful but not transformational.
- Blame culture and learning culture cannot coexist. Every time you assign blame, you reduce the quality of your next review.

KEY INSIGHT
What significant event in the last 90 days deserved an After-Action Review but didn't get one?

FRAMEWORK

The Five Dysfunctions of a Team

These five dysfunctions form a hierarchy. You cannot fix accountability if commitment is absent. You cannot build commitment without healthy conflict.

1. 1. Absence of Trust: the foundation. Without it, nothing above it is possible.
2. 2. Fear of Conflict: artificial harmony. Important issues stay underground.
3. 3. Lack of Commitment: ambiguity in decisions. People leave without genuine alignment.
4. 4. Avoidance of Accountability: missed commitments go unaddressed. Standards drift.
5. 5. Inattention to Results: individual agendas or team status over collective outcomes.

REFLECT ON THIS

What will your team be capable of after you've moved on that they couldn't do before you arrived?

> That question — and your honesty in answering it — is the measure of your development as a manager.

TRY THIS

Three team development actions for this week:

1. Have one genuine development conversation (not a check-in) with the team member you've most neglected.

2. Have one stay conversation with a high-value team member. Ask: what keeps you here?

3. Facilitate a 30-minute After-Action Review on a recent significant event. Produce one specific action.

The Focused Leader

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